

So here's how to make text look anything from jazzy to drab, make it twist and turn, or grow and shrink; how to shoot it up with bullets or arrows (among other things), how to pack it up in small and large boxes, and—if your inner Van Gogh is just waiting to push out of your fingers—how to make your words works of art in themselves.

6.1 Fonts

If handwriting significantly changes the way in which you understand a handwritten document, the look of the words can make or break the most well-planned presentation. So, before you get down to putting in your powerful points on the slide, you'll need to know what you can do to make your text look better, clearer, and—most importantly, more readable. For that, you'll have to understand fonts.

6.1.1 What Is A Font?

Simply put, a font is nothing but a complete set of characters—letters, numbers, symbols—that are of a particular style (which is also known as a specific typeface). So a particular font, if chosen, gives all the text you've selected the same look, the same sort of “lettering.” Just imagine every font as a different kind of handwriting. How terrific it would be if we could alter our handwriting at will... PowerPoint, like other programs, lets you do just that.

6.1.2 What's The Big Deal Anyway?

A presentation has to be readable before it is anything else. The hallmarks of a good presentation are *consistency* and *readability*. Colours, graphics, and animation can make your presentation eye-catching and attention-grabbing. But we should remind you that PowerPoint is PowerPoint. If the main points on your slides are illegible, inappropriate, or indecipherable, you have, well, missed the point. Just the nature of the typeface—the size, weight (medium or bold), posture (angle or stance)—could determine whether your presentation is formal or informal, academic or corporate, aggressive or soft, and so forth. Remember how the kid with the